DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE AND DATA GOVERNANCE

RAILS, SERVICE AND SAFEGUARD → THE STACK CARD → TWO CONSENT CONSTRUCTS → LAYER-SPECIFIC RISK MATRIX → THREE-TRANCHE COMMENCEMENT → THE SECTION 44 SPLIT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◈ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 RAILS, SERVICE AND SAFEGUARD

RAILS, SERVICE AND SAFEGUARD · IDENTITY, PAYMENTS, DOCUMENTS, CONSENT, COMMERCE AND HEALTH INFRASTRUCTURE · A SPECIFIC DEPARTMENTAL PORTAL DELIVERED ON THOSE RAILS · THE DATA-PROTECTION STATUTE, RULES AND ENFORCING BODY · WHY IT MATTERS · RAILS RAISE SYSTEMIC RISKS; A SERVICE RAISES DEPARTMENTAL ONES · MUST REMEMBER · DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE SUPPLIES REUSABLE POPULATION-SCALE RAILS FOR

CORE CLAIM

- RAILS → identity, payments, documents, consent, commerce and health infrastructure
- SERVICE → a specific departmental portal delivered on those rails

MECHANISM

- SAFEGUARD → the data-protection statute, rules and enforcing body
- WHY IT MATTERS → rails raise systemic risks; a service raises departmental ones

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MUST REMEMBER: Digital public infrastructure supplies reusable population-scale rails for...
- RAILS → identity, payments, documents, consent, commerce and health infrastructure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Digital public infrastructure supplies reusable population-scale rails for.

01

STAGE 01 THE STACK CARD

THE STACK CARD · AADHAAR UNDER THE AADHAAR ACT, 2016; UIDAI: NOT PROOF · UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE OPERATED BY THE NATIONAL PAYMENTS CORPORATION · DIGILOCKER UNDER THE MINISTRY OF ELECTRONICS AND INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY · ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR REGULATED BY THE RESERVE BANK OF INDIA · COMMERCE AND HEALTH · OPEN NETWORK FOR DIGITAL COMMERCE; AYUSHMAN BHARAT DIGITAL MISSION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
IDENTITY → Aadhaar under the Aadhaar Act, 2016; UIDAI: not proof of citizenship	DOCUMENTS → DigiLocker under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology	COMMERCE AND HEALTH → Open Network for Digital Commerce; Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission
PAYMENTS → Unified Payments Interface operated by the National Payments Corporation of India	CONSENT → Account Aggregator regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under DEPA	IDENTITY → Aadhaar under the Aadhaar Act, 2016; UIDAI: not proof of citizenship

CORE CLAIM

- IDENTITY → Aadhaar under the Aadhaar Act, 2016; UIDAI: not proof of citizenship
- PAYMENTS → Unified Payments Interface operated by the National Payments Corporation of India

MECHANISM

- DOCUMENTS → DigiLocker under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology
- CONSENT → Account Aggregator regulated by the Reserve Bank of India under DEPA

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- COMMERCE AND HEALTH → Open Network for Digital Commerce; Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission
- IDENTITY → Aadhaar under the Aadhaar Act, 2016; UIDAI: not proof of citizenship

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMMERCE AND HEALTH → Open Network for Digital Commerce; Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission.

02

STAGE 02 TWO CONSENT CONSTRUCTS

TWO CONSENT CONSTRUCTS · ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR · FINANCE-SPECIFIC; RESERVE BANK REGULATED; CANNOT VIEW OR STORE THE · CONSENT MANAGER · GENERAL-PURPOSE REGISTRATION UNDER THE 2025 RULES; COMMENCES 13 NOVEMBER · SHARED LOGIC · GIVE, MANAGE, REVIEW AND WITHDRAW CONSENT THROUGH AN INTEROPERABLE · ERROR PREVENTED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR → finance-specific Reserve Bank regulated; cannot view or store the data	SHARED LOGIC → give, manage, review and withdraw consent through an interoperable platform	ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR → finance-specific Reserve Bank regulated; cannot view or store the data
CONSENT MANAGER → general-purpose registration under the 2025 Rules; commences 13 November 2026	ERROR PREVENTED → treating one registration as the other in a close-option question	CONSENT MANAGER → general-purpose registration under the 2025 Rules; commences 13 November 2026

CORE CLAIM

- ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR → finance-specific Reserve Bank regulated; cannot view or store the data
- CONSENT MANAGER → general-purpose registration under the 2025 Rules; commences 13 November 2026

MECHANISM

- SHARED LOGIC → give, manage, review and withdraw consent through an interoperable platform
- ERROR PREVENTED → treating one registration as the other in a close-option question

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR → finance-specific Reserve Bank regulated; cannot view or store the data
- CONSENT MANAGER → general-purpose registration under the 2025 Rules; commences 13 November 2026

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ERROR PREVENTED → treating one registration as the other in a close-option question.

03

STAGE 03 LAYER-SPECIFIC RISK MATRIX

LAYER-SPECIFIC RISK MATRIX · WHO IS EXCLUDED BY AUTHENTICATION FAILURE · PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS · WHO LACKS THE DEVICE, CONNECTIVITY OR LITERACY TO SELF-SERVE · DOES THE OPEN PROTOCOL GIVE SMALLER SELLERS GENUINELY EQUAL · IS SENSITIVE DATA WITH HIGHER RE-IDENTIFICATION RISK ADEQUATELY SAFEGUARDED

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure	COMMERCE → does the open protocol give smaller sellers genuinely equal visibility	IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure
PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS → who lacks the device, connectivity or literacy to self-serve	HEALTH → is sensitive data with higher re-identification risk adequately safeguarded	PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS → who lacks the device, connectivity or literacy to self-serve

CORE CLAIM

- IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure
- PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS → who lacks the device, connectivity or literacy to self-serve

MECHANISM

- COMMERCE → does the open protocol give smaller sellers genuinely equal visibility
- HEALTH → is sensitive data with higher re-identification risk adequately safeguarded

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- IDENTITY → who is excluded by authentication failure
- PAYMENTS AND DOCUMENTS → who lacks the device, connectivity or literacy to self-serve

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HEALTH → is sensitive data with higher re-identification risk adequately safeguarded.

04

STAGE 04 THREE-TRANCHE COMMENCEMENT

THREE-TRANCHE COMMENCEMENT · 13 NOVEMBER 2025 · DEFINITIONS, SECTIONS 18 TO 26 ESTABLISHING THE BOARD, SECTION · 13 NOVEMBER 2026 · SECTION 6(9) CONSENT MANAGERS AND SECTION 27(1)(D); · 13 MAY 2027 · SECTIONS 3 TO 5, SECTIONS 7 TO 17 RIGHTS · G.S.R. 843(E) COMMENCEMENT; G.S.R. 846(E) RULES; G.S.R. 892(E) CORRIGENDUM

13 NOVEMBER 2025 → definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, section 44(1) and → 13 NOVEMBER 2026 → section 6(9) consent managers and section 27(1)(d) → 13 MAY 2027 → sections 3 to 5, sections 7 to 17 rights, sections 27 → NOTIFICATIONS → G.S.R. 843(E) commencement; G.S.R. 846(E) Rules; G.S.R. 892(E) corrigendum

CORE CLAIM

- 13 NOVEMBER 2025 → definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, section 44(1) and 44(3)
- 13 NOVEMBER 2026 → section 6(9) consent managers and section 27(1)(d)

MECHANISM

- 13 MAY 2027 → sections 3 to 5, sections 7 to 17 rights, sections 27 to 34 and section 44(2)
- NOTIFICATIONS → G.S.R. 843(E) commencement; G.S.R. 846(E) Rules; G.S.R. 892(E) corrigendum

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- 13 NOVEMBER 2025 → definitions, sections 18 to 26 establishing the Board, section 44(1) and 44(3)
- 13 NOVEMBER 2026 → section 6(9) consent managers and section 27(1)(d)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NOTIFICATIONS → G.S.R. 843(E) commencement; G.S.R. 846(E) Rules; G.S.R. 892(E) corrigendum.

05

STAGE 05 THE SECTION 44 SPLIT

THE SECTION 44 SPLIT · SECTION 44(3) · SUBSTITUTES THE PERSONAL-INFORMATION EXEMPTION IN THE TRANSPARENCY STATUTE · IMMEDIATE TRANCHE; OPERATIVE SINCE 13 AND 14 NOVEMBER 2025 · SECTION 44(2) · AMENDS THE INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY ACT, 2000 · DEFERRED TO 13 MAY 2027; CHALLENGES FILED AND NO · CLOSE DISTINCTION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SECTION 44(3) → substitutes the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute	SECTION 44(2) → amends the Information Technology Act, 2000	CLOSE DISTINCTION: DPI is not every government portal, a digital identity is not...
STATUS → immediate tranche; operative since 13 and 14 November 2025	STATUS → deferred to 13 May 2027; challenges filed and no final judgment located	SECTION 44(3) → substitutes the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute

CORE CLAIM

- SECTION 44(3) → substitutes the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute
- STATUS → immediate tranche; operative since 13 and 14 November 2025

MECHANISM

- SECTION 44(2) → amends the Information Technology Act, 2000
- STATUS → deferred to 13 May 2027; challenges filed and no final judgment located

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: DPI is not every government portal, a digital identity is not...
- SECTION 44(3) → substitutes the personal-information exemption in the transparency statute

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: DPI is not every government portal, a digital identity is not.

06

STAGE 06 ENFORCEMENT SEQUENCE

ENFORCEMENT SEQUENCE · STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED · THE BOARD EXISTS IN LAW UNDER SECTION 18 · STAGE 2 RECRUITMENT · APPLICATIONS INVITED IN MAY 2026 FOR ONE CHAIRPERSON AND · STAGE 3 PROCEDURE · RULES OF PROCEDURE AND DIGITAL-FIRST CONDUCT OF PROCEEDINGS · STAGE 4 AND 5 · INCLUSION AT THE MEDIAN WITH A DENIAL TAIL AMONG · OFFLINE OVERRIDE, WHICH REINTRODUCES SOME DISCRETION; A TRADE-OFF, NOT

STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED → the Board exists in law under section 18 → STAGE 2 RECRUITMENT → applications invited in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members → STAGE 3 PROCEDURE → rules of procedure and digital-first conduct of proceedings → STAGE 4 AND 5 → commenced substantive duties, then decided cases → CAUTION → no appointment order located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off

CORE CLAIM

- STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED → the Board exists in law under section 18
- STAGE 2 RECRUITMENT → applications invited in May 2026 for one Chairperson and four Members

MECHANISM

- STAGE 3 PROCEDURE → rules of procedure and digital-first conduct of proceedings
- STAGE 4 AND 5 → commenced substantive duties, then decided cases

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CAUTION → no appointment order located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off
- STAGE 1 ESTABLISHED → the Board exists in law under section 18

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → no appointment order located by the 21 July 2026 cut-off.

07

STAGE 07 AUTHENTICATION DEPENDENCY

AUTHENTICATION DEPENDENCY · POPULATION-SCALE IDENTITY · EFFICIENT TARGETING AND DE-DUPLICATION · ACCESS BECOMES CONDITIONAL ON SUCCESSFUL VERIFICATION · FAILURE MODES · WORN BIOMETRICS, CONNECTIVITY DROP, ADDRESS MISMATCH · INCLUSION AT THE MEDIAN WITH A DENIAL TAIL AMONG · OFFLINE OVERRIDE, WHICH REINTRODUCES SOME DISCRETION; A TRADE-OFF, NOT

POPULATION-SCALE IDENTITY → efficient targeting and de-duplication → AUTHENTICATION DEPENDENCY → access becomes conditional on successful verification → FAILURE MODES → worn biometrics, connectivity drop, address mismatch → OUTCOME → inclusion at the median with a denial tail among intended beneficiaries → MITIGATION → offline override, which reintroduces some discretion; a trade-off, not a fix

CORE CLAIM

- POPULATION-SCALE IDENTITY → efficient targeting and de-duplication
- AUTHENTICATION DEPENDENCY → access becomes conditional on successful verification

MECHANISM

- FAILURE MODES → worn biometrics, connectivity drop, address mismatch
- OUTCOME → inclusion at the median with a denial tail among intended beneficiaries

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MITIGATION → offline override, which reintroduces some discretion; a trade-off, not a fix
- POPULATION-SCALE IDENTITY → efficient targeting and de-duplication

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MITIGATION → offline override, which reintroduces some discretion; a trade-off, not a fix.

08

STAGE 08 INTEROPERABILITY AGAINST PURPOSE LIMITATION

INTEROPERABILITY AGAINST PURPOSE LIMITATION · THE SAME RAILS REUSED ACROSS MANY PUBLIC AND PRIVATE · PURPOSE LIMITATION · DATA COLLECTED FOR ONE PURPOSE MAY NOT BE SILENTLY · GRANULAR PURPOSE-SPECIFIC CONSENT, PURPOSE TAGGING, DATA MINIMISATION · PRACTICAL FAILURE · CONSENT FATIGUE, MEANING HABITUAL APPROVAL WITHOUT COMPREHENSION

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
INTEROPERABILITY → the same rails reused across many public and private services	RECONCILERS → granular purpose-specific consent, purpose tagging, data minimisation	INTEROPERABILITY → the same rails reused across many public and private services
PURPOSE LIMITATION → data collected for one purpose may not be silently reused	PRACTICAL FAILURE → consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension	PURPOSE LIMITATION → data collected for one purpose may not be silently reused

CORE CLAIM

- INTEROPERABILITY → the same rails reused across many public and private services
- PURPOSE LIMITATION → data collected for one purpose may not be silently reused

MECHANISM

- RECONCILERS → granular purpose-specific consent, purpose tagging, data minimisation
- PRACTICAL FAILURE → consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- INTEROPERABILITY → the same rails reused across many public and private services
- PURPOSE LIMITATION → data collected for one purpose may not be silently reused

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PRACTICAL FAILURE → consent fatigue, meaning habitual approval without comprehension.

09

STAGE 09 SIX BINDING CONSTRAINTS

SIX BINDING CONSTRAINTS · HOUSEHOLD HANDSET SHARED AND CONTROLLED BY ONE MEMBER · QUALITY AND COST, NOT MERELY COVERAGE · CONTENT AND ERROR MESSAGES OUTSIDE THE USER'S SCRIPT · FUNCTIONAL LITERACY · COMPLETING A TASK, NOT OPERATING A PHONE · TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION · FEAR OF ERROR, WORN FINGERPRINTS, ADDRESS MISMATCH

DEVICE → household handset shared and controlled by one member → CONNECTIVITY → quality and cost, not merely coverage → LANGUAGE → content and error messages outside the user's script → FUNCTIONAL LITERACY → completing a task, not operating a phone → TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION → fear of error, worn fingerprints, address mismatch

CORE CLAIM

- DEVICE → household handset shared and controlled by one member
- CONNECTIVITY → quality and cost, not merely coverage

MECHANISM

- LANGUAGE → content and error messages outside the user's script
- FUNCTIONAL LITERACY → completing a task, not operating a phone

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION → fear of error, worn fingerprints, address mismatch
- DEVICE → household handset shared and controlled by one member

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRUST AND AUTHENTICATION → fear of error, worn fingerprints, address mismatch.

10

STAGE 10 INTERMEDIARY PARADOX AND FOUR SAFEGUARDS

INTERMEDIARY PARADOX AND FOUR SAFEGUARDS · REALISTIC ROUTE · ASSISTED ACCESS THROUGH A CENTRE, A SHOPKEEPER OR A · NEW RISK · A FEE, AN ERROR RATE AND ACCESS TO THE · SAFEGUARDS 1 AND 2 · NECESSITY AND PROPORTIONALITY; MINIMISATION WITH PURPOSE TAGGING · SAFEGUARDS 3 AND 4

REALISTIC ROUTE → assisted access through a centre, a shopkeeper or a family member → NEW RISK → a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's own credentials → SAFEGUARDS 1 AND 2 → necessity and proportionality; minimisation with purpose tagging → SAFEGUARDS 3 AND 4 → assisted and offline fallback; reasoned human review and appeal

CORE CLAIM

- REALISTIC ROUTE → assisted access through a centre, a shopkeeper or a family member
- NEW RISK → a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's own credentials

MECHANISM

- SAFEGUARDS 1 AND 2 → necessity and proportionality; minimisation with purpose tagging
- SAFEGUARDS 3 AND 4 → assisted and offline fallback; reasoned human review and appeal

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- REALISTIC ROUTE → assisted access through a centre, a shopkeeper or a family member
- NEW RISK → a fee, an error rate and access to the citizen's own credentials

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFEGUARDS 3 AND 4 → assisted and offline fallback; reasoned human review and appeal.

11

STAGE 11 ANSWER SPINE FOR AN ADEQUACY DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR AN ADEQUACY DEMAND · SEPARATE RAILS, SERVICE AND SAFEGUARD, AND NAME THE LAYER · STATE THE TRANCHE, THE SECTION AND THE DATE BEFORE · EXCLUSION TAIL, CONSENT QUALITY, REUSE TENSION, ENFORCEMENT STAGE · GRADED VERDICT WITH A PENDING-CHALLENGE CAVEAT AND CORRECT GRIEVANCE · EVIDENCE LIMIT · USE AADHAAR, UPI, DIGILOCKER, ACCOUNT

OPEN → separate rails, service and safeguard, and name the layer at issue → BUILD → state the tranche, the section and the date before evaluating adequacy → TEST → exclusion tail, consent quality, reuse tension, enforcement stage → CLOSE → graded verdict with a pending-challenge caveat and correct grievance routing → EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Aadhaar, UPI, DigiLocker, Account

CORE CLAIM

- OPEN → separate rails, service and safeguard, and name the layer at issue
- BUILD → state the tranche, the section and the date before evaluating adequacy

MECHANISM

- TEST → exclusion tail, consent quality, reuse tension, enforcement stage
- CLOSE → graded verdict with a pending-challenge caveat and correct grievance routing

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Aadhaar, UPI, DigiLocker, Account...
- OPEN → separate rails, service and safeguard, and name the layer at issue

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict with a pending-challenge caveat and correct grievance routing.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE 2017 JUSTICE K.S. PUTTASWAMY JUDGMENT (A POLITY/FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS · ONDC'S OPEN-PROTOCOL LOGIC EXTENDS DPI'S "RAILS, NOT PLATFORM" PHILOSOPHY · ABDM'S HEALTH-DATA MODEL RAISES A DISTINCT SENSITIVITY-TIER ISSUE · HEALTH DATA CARRIES · THE DIGITAL PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION RULES, 2025 WERE NOTIFIED · THE DPBI WAS LEGALLY ESTABLISHED AND MEITY ADVERTISED ONE · RBI'S ACCOUNT AGGREGATOR REGULATORY FRAMEWORK LONG PRECEDED THE DPDP

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH	ADVANCED DEBATE	LEGACY / NUANCE
• CAUTION: The 2017 Justice K.S. Puttaswamy judgment (a Polity/Fundamental Rights topic) supplies	• The DPBI was legally established and MeitY advertised one Chairperson and four Member	• CAUTION: ONDC enabling a small local retailer to reach buyers across platforms without
• CAUTION: ONDC's open-protocol logic extends DPI's "rails, not platform" philosophy to commerce;	• CAUTION: RBI's Account Aggregator regulatory framework long preceded the DPDP Act, illustrating	• CAUTION: Interoperability (DPI's core value proposition) and purpose limitation (DPDP's core
• CAUTION: ABDM's health-data model raises a distinct sensitivity-tier issue: health data carries	• CAUTION: A rural PDS beneficiary denied grain due to biometric authentication failure despite	• CAUTION: Authentication-based service delivery improves efficiency for the majority while
• The Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified by MeitY on 13 November	• CAUTION: Boundary case: a Consent Manager platform that presents consent requests in dense legal	• CAUTION: A legally established but not-yet-appointed Board has no case-outcome evidence.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels